

Melissa Pavlik

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ACADEMIC POSTS

- 2027 (*Sched.*) **Tulane University**
Assistant Professor
Political Economy (the Murphy Institute) and Political Science
- 2026 **Tulane University**
Faculty Fellow
Political Economy (the Murphy Institute) and Political Science
- 2025 **Wesleyan University**
Visiting instructor
Politics Department
- 2023–2024 **University of Lagos (Nigeria)**
Visiting researcher
Center for Sustainable Housing and Urban Development

EDUCATION

- 2026 **Ph.D. in Political Science, Yale University**
with distinction
Dissertation: Producing Precarity: The Coercive Logic Selective State Enforcement
Committee: Katharine Baldwin (co-chair), Sarah Sunn Bush, Gerard Padró i Miquel, Elisabeth Wood (co-chair)
Fields: Comparative Politics, Quantitative Methodology, International Relations
- 2018 **M.A. in War Studies, King's College London (UK)**
with distinction
- 2016 **B.A. in Political Science (Minor in Statistics), University of Chicago**
with honors

RESEARCH

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- Grasse, Donald, **Melissa Pavlik**, Hilary Matfess and Travis B. Curtice 2021. "Opportunistic Repression: Patterns of Civilian Targeting by the State in Response to COVID-19" *International Security* 46 (2): 130–165. DOI: 10.1162/isec_a.00419
- Starc Card, K., B. Muhire, J. Wilson, C.B. Akawu, B. Bukar, S. Rincon, A. Meaux, Z. Ahmadu, **M. Pavlik**, B. Fodde., H. Ayuba, C. Smith, & A. N.-N Almassri. 2025. "Not a voluntary, sustainable, or scalable outcome: Resilience in urban settings of fragility in sub-Saharan Africa." *Environment and Security*, 4(3), 270-290. DOI: 10.1177/27538796251395446

UNDER REVIEW & SUBMITTED

Grasse, Donald and Melissa Pavlik. 2026. “Climate Change, Conflict, and Property Rights: Evidence from Nigeria.” Under review.

Bush, Sarah Sunn, Jennifer Hadden and Melissa Pavlik. 2026. “Mind the Gaps: Assessing Missingness and Its Implications in INGO Datasets.” Under review.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

Pavlik, Melissa. “Connivance and Coercion: Spatial Networks of Enforcement in Lagos, Nigeria.” 2026. *Job market paper*.

Pavlik, Melissa. “Mapping the Margins: Geospatial Methods for the Measurement of Informal Economies.” 2026.

Pavlik, Melissa and Ryan Pike. 2026. “Words of Warcraft: Experimental Evidence on Norm Subversion Following Russia’s Invasion of Ukraine”

BOOK PROJECT

Pavlik, Melissa. *Producing Precarity: The Coercive Logic of Selective State Enforcement*.

SELECTED ANALYSIS & GENERAL AUDIENCE

Pavlik, Melissa. 2022. “To Understand Global Conflict, Start With a Map.” *World Politics Review (WPR)*

Pavlik, Melissa. 2022. “The West’s Border Closure Reflex Comes With a Cost.” *World Politics Review (WPR)*.

Pavlik, Melissa. 2021. “The Horror and the Humanity: Review of Samuel Moyn’s Humane.” Roundtable on Samuel Moyn’s Humane. *Tocqueville 21*

Pavlik, Melissa. 2021. “Democracies Bear Some Blame for Democracy’s Global Erosion.” *World Politics Review (WPR)*

Pavlik, Melissa. 2021. “Anti-Interventionism Isn’t Enough For Left Foreign Policy.” *Foreign Policy* (online + print edition)

Grasse, Don, Melissa Pavlik, Hilary Matfess, and Travis B. Curtice. 2020. “Autocratic Governments Are Using Coronavirus as a Pretext to Clamp Down on Opponents.” *Washington Post Monkey Cage*

Pavlik, Melissa. 2020. “A Great and Sudden Change: The Global Political Violence Landscape Before and After COVID-19.” *Armed Conflict Location & Event Data Project (ACLED)*

Kishi, Roudabeh, Melissa Pavlik and Sam Jones. 2020. “ACLED 2019: The Year in Review.” *Armed Conflict Location & Event Data Project (ACLED)*

Kishi, Roudabeh, Melissa Pavlik and Hilary Matfess. 2020. “‘Terrible and Terrifyingly Normal’: Political Violence Targeting Women.” *Armed Conflict Location & Event Data Project (ACLED)*

GRANTS

2024	18,000 USD	International Dissertation Research Fellowship (IDRF) from the MacMillan Center for International and Area Studies at Yale University
	15,000 USD	Interdisciplinary Experimental Research Grant from the Institute for Social and Policy Studies at Yale University
	5,000 USD	Nuclear Security Policy Fellowship from the Nuclear Security Program at Yale University
2023	15,000 USD	Doctoral Dissertation Research Improvement Grant (DDRIG) , National Science Foundation via American Political Science Association
	5,000 USD	International Research Grant From International Security Studies (ISS) Center at Yale University
	5,000 USD	Pre-Dissertation Research Grant from the MacMillan Center for International and Area Studies at Yale University

TEACHING

FALL 2026	POLITICAL ECONOMY OF CONFLICT & CLIMATE CHANGE <i>Instructor</i> Political Economy, Tulane University
SPRING 2026	AFRICA IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS <i>Instructor of Record</i> Politics, Wesleyan University
FALL 2025	GAME THEORY AND POLITICAL SCIENCE <i>Teaching Fellow</i> Prof. Ian Turner, Political Science, Yale University
FALL 2024	GAME THEORY AND POLITICAL SCIENCE <i>Teaching Fellow</i> Prof. Ian Turner, Political Science, Yale University
FALL 2023	CONTESTING INJUSTICE <i>Teaching Fellow</i> Prof. Elisabeth Wood, Political Science, Yale University
SPRING 2023	GOVERNANCE & POLITICS IN AFRICA <i>Teaching Fellow</i> Prof. Kate Baldwin, Political Science, Yale University
FALL 2022	INTRODUCTION TO PROBABILITY THEORY <i>Teaching Fellow</i> Prof. Robert Wooster, Statistics & Data Science, Yale University

SERVICE

Editorial Assistant: APSR (Elisabeth Wood, 2021-2023; Alexandre Debs, 2024 & 2025).

Interviewer: APSA Comparative Politics “Pathbreaking Women in Comparative Politics” series (2025, Susan Rose-Ackerman)

Student Coordinator: Leitner Political Economy Workshop at Yale University, 2022–2024.

Peer Reviewer: *Comparative Politics*, 2026, *Journal of Experimental Political Science (JEPS)*, 2022; *International Interactions*, 2021

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2025	Yale Leitner Program on Political Economy
2025	European Political Science Association (EPSA)
2025	Boston Area Working Group on African Political Economy (BWGAPE)
2025	Northeast Workshop on Empirical Political Science (NEWEPS)
2025	Comparative Labor Politics Group at APSA
2024	Virtual International Political Economy Studies (VIPES)
2024	American Political Science Association (APSA)
2024	European Political Science Association (EPSA)
2024	Political Economy of International Organizations (PEIO)
2023	Boston Area Working Group on African Political Economy (BWGAPE)
2023	Yale Leitner Program on Political Economy
2023	American Political Science Association (APSA)
2023	Midwestern Political Science Association (MPSA)
2022	American Political Science Association (APSA)
2022	Midwestern Political Science Association (MPSA)
2021	American Political Science Association (APSA)
2020	Oxford Conflict Dynamics
2019	Households in Conflict Network (HiCN)

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